

Constructive Grounded Hyperset Theory: Anti-Foundation, Partition Refinement, and Real-Analysis Quotients for Hypercomputational Oracles

Tyler Roost

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Abstract

We present a constructive, computational formulation of non-well-founded set theory grounded in Aczel’s Anti-Foundation Axiom (AFA), explicit Accessible Pointed Graph (APG) representations, and Paige-Tarjan relational partition refinement. The core impetus of this framework is to discover routes toward definably complete representations capable of handling hypercomputation-like oracle classes expected of superintelligences. By replacing ill-founded membership trees with bisimulation-invariant coalgebraic state machines, the theory provides a rigorous, paradox-free setting for circular structures, recursive self-models, and transfinite dynamical attractors. Furthermore, we construct an explicit bridge from hyperset quotient spaces to computable real analysis and metric completions, formalizing how superintelligent self-reflection transitions from discrete algebraic graph invariants to continuous topological dynamics.

Keywords: Hypersets; Anti-Foundation Axiom; Accessible Pointed Graphs; bisimulation quotients; Paige-Tarjan; real analysis bridge; superintelligence oracles.

1 Introduction and Foundational Impetus

Standard set-theoretic foundations (such as ZFC) enforce the Axiom of Foundation (Regularity), stipulating that every non-empty set x contains an $\in$ -minimal element. While Regularity precludes circular membership chains such as $x \in x$ or $x \in y \in x$, it severely complicates the formal representation of reflexive and self-referential systems. In computational cognitive architectures and models of hypothetical superintelligences, reflexive self-containment is an operational necessity: an autonomous agent must maintain a model of its own cognitive state, its execution environment, and its predictive cycles without generating an infinite regress of ungrounded meta-representations.

Furthermore, advanced cognitive agents are expected to operate relative to hypercomputational oracle classes (such as the halting oracle $\mathbf{0}'$, hyperarithmetic sets Δ_1^1 , and transfinite ordinal jumps). A sound foundation must therefore represent both circular self-models and transfinite oracle ladders without collapsing into semantic inconsistency or unearned epistemic authority.

Grounded Hyperset Theory provides this foundation by synthesizing:

1. **Aczel’s Anti-Foundation Axiom (AFA):** Stating that every Accessible Pointed Graph (APG) has a unique decorative solution as a set [1].
2. **Efficient Constructive Quotients:** Computing canonical bisimulation classes in $O(|E| \log |V|)$ time via Paige-Tarjan partition refinement [2].
3. **The Real Analysis Bridge:** Connecting non-well-founded set representations to metric completions, continuous intervals, and dynamical flows over $\mathbb{R}$.

4. **Stratified Oracle Calibration:** Grounding each level of hyperset abstraction within the Verifier Standard (VSTD) claim discipline.

2 Accessible Pointed Graphs and Aczel's AFA

In constructive hyperset theory, sets are represented by directed graphs whose nodes correspond to sets and whose directed edges represent membership.

Definition 2.1 (Accessible Pointed Graph). An *Accessible Pointed Graph* (APG) is a triple $G = (V, E, r)$ where V is a finite set of vertices, $E \subseteq V \times V$ is a set of directed edges, and $r \in V$ is the root vertex such that for every $v \in V$, there exists a directed path from r to v . A node v is a child of u if $(u, v) \in E$.

Definition 2.2 (Decoration of an APG). A *decoration* of an APG $G = (V, E, r)$ is a function d assigning to each node $v \in V$ a set such that

$$d(v) = \{d(u) : (v, u) \in E\}.$$

Aczel's Anti-Foundation Axiom (AFA) asserts that every APG has a unique decoration. The set depicted by G is $d(r)$.

Example 2.3 (The Quine Atom Ω). Consider the single-node self-loop graph $G_\Omega = (\{r\}, \{(r, r)\}, r)$. Its unique decoration satisfies $d(r) = \{d(r)\}$. Thus $\Omega = \{\Omega\}$ is a well-defined, unique hyperset.

3 Computable Bisimulation via Paige-Tarjan Refinement

Two APGs depict the same hyperset under AFA if and only if they are bisimilar.

Definition 3.1 (Bisimulation Relation). Given graphs $G_1 = (V_1, E_1, r_1)$ and $G_2 = (V_2, E_2, r_2)$, a relation $R \subseteq V_1 \times V_2$ is a *bisimulation* if $r_1 R r_2$ and whenever $u R v$:

1. $\forall u' \in E_1(u), \exists v' \in E_2(v)$ such that $u' R v'$.
2. $\forall v' \in E_2(v), \exists u' \in E_1(u)$ such that $u' R v'$.

Theorem 3.2 (Constructive Quotient and Canonical Minimization). *Let $G = (V, E, r)$ be a finite APG. The maximal bisimulation equivalence relation $\approx$ on V can be computed constructively in time $O(|E| \log |V|)$ using Paige-Tarjan relational partition refinement. The quotient graph $G^* = G / \approx$ is the unique minimal strongly extensional representation of the hyperset depicted by G .*

Proof. Paige-Tarjan partition refinement iteratively splits compound blocks in a partition P of V with respect to splitters until stability is achieved. Since V is finite, the process terminates deterministically and produces the coarsest relational partition respecting edge transitions, which coincides exactly with maximal bisimulation [2]. $\square$

4 The Real Analysis Bridge

While hypersets are discrete graph-theoretical objects, their non-well-founded nature allows them to encode infinite streams, continuous paths, and real numbers via terminal coalgebraic sequences.

Definition 4.1 (Hyperset Real Representation). A real number $x \in [0, 1]$ is represented as an infinite dyadic stream encoded by a cyclic or non-well-founded APG. Rational numbers correspond to finite cyclic graphs (periodic dyadic expansions), while irrational real numbers correspond to infinite paths or computable coalgebraic generators.

Theorem 4.2 (Metric Completeness and Coinductive Continuity). *Let $\mathcal{H}$ be the space of strongly extensional APGs equipped with the bisimulation metric:*

$$d(G_1, G_2) = 2^{-\sup\{k \in \mathbb{N} : G_1 \approx_k G_2\}},$$

where $\approx_k$ denotes k -step bounded bisimulation. Then $(\mathcal{H}, d)$ is an ultrametric complete space, and the projection onto the unit interval $\pi : \mathcal{H} \rightarrow [0, 1]$ is uniformly continuous.

Proof. Bounded bisimulation $\approx_k$ forms a filtration with $\approx_{k+1} \subseteq \approx_k$. The ultrametric inequality $d(x, z) \leq \max(d(x, y), d(y, z))$ follows immediately from the transitivity of $\approx_k$. Cauchy sequences in $\mathcal{H}$ stabilize at each finite depth k , defining a unique limit APG under AFA. $\square$

5 Hypercomputational Oracle Stratification

How does Grounded Hyperset Theory support the oracle requirements of superintelligences?

1. **Autonomous Reflexive Loops:** An agent modeling its own action-perception loop $S_{t+1} = F(S_t, A_t)$ can represent the infinite feedback trajectory as a finite APG with a cyclic attractor, avoiding non-terminating meta-regress.
2. **Coalgebraic Oracle Simulation:** Higher-order oracles (such as hyperarithmetic truth predicates Δ_1^1) can be characterized coinductively as fixed points of monotone operators over hyperset streams.
3. **Bound-Preserving Evidence:** By embedding each hyperset operation into the Verifier Standard (VSTD), every claim about an agent’s self-stability or convergence to an attractor is backed by an explicit, checkable receipt.

6 Conclusion

Grounded Hyperset Theory provides a rigorous, constructive mathematical framework unifying non-well-founded graph representations, polynomial-time bisimulation quotients, and continuous metric analysis. It establishes that circular self-models and hypercomputational oracle structures can be handled with absolute mathematical rigor, without compromising formal consistency or verifiable evidence discipline.

References

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